

The music Package

Simple staff notation, drawn from the document language

1 Reading a score

The `music` package draws a line of staff notation on a treble clef. A score is a list of notes: a letter `a–g` for the pitch, optional `'` or `,` to raise or lower it an octave, and an optional duration digit — `1` whole, `2` half, `4` quarter (the default), `8` eighth. A `|` is a barline. The heads, clefs, flags, rests, accidentals and time-signature figures are real engraved glyphs from Bravura, the reference font for music notation; the stems, beams, staff lines and ledger lines are ruled over the `\picture` layer.

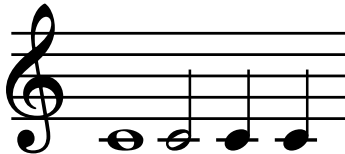
2 A scale

The C major scale, an octave of quarter notes from middle C — which sits on its own ledger line below the staff — up to the C above.



3 Durations

The same C, held for a whole note, a half, a quarter, and an eighth. The longer notes have open heads; the stem appears at the half note, and the flag at the eighth.



4 A melody

The opening of *Mary Had a Little Lamb*, with barlines and a half note to close each phrase.



And the start of *Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star*.



Notes far above or below the staff hang on short ledger lines, drawn only as far as the note reaches.

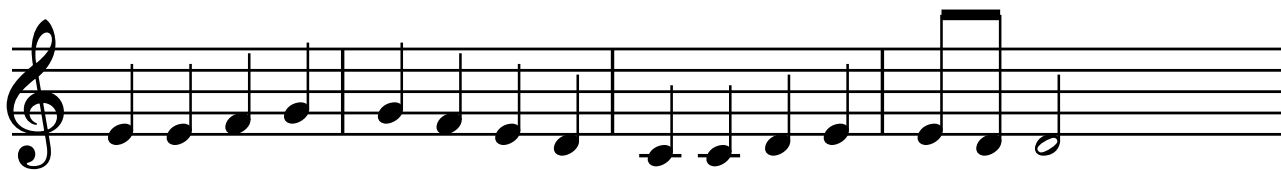


An accidental leads a note: + for a sharp, - for a flat, **n** for a natural. The sign is drawn just left of the head; it changes how the note is read, not where it sits, so **+f** and **f** share a line. Here a chromatic climb, then a sharpened note cancelled by a natural.



Eighth notes in a run are usually joined by a beam rather than each carrying its own flag. Bracket a group with [and] and the notes between share one beam.





8 Time signatures

Setting `\set musicctimenum` and `\set musicctimeden` draws a time signature after the clef. Three-four time, a waltz, with the beats grouped into bars.



9 The bass clef

Setting `\set musicclef {bass}` notates in the bass clef instead, where middle C sits one ledger line *above* the staff. Here a C major scale from the C below the staff up to middle C.

